National Centre for Advanced Studies (NCAS)

CORPORATE GOALS, OBJECTIVES AND STRATEGIES

2025-2029

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Vision

"To be a Centre of excellence of national and international repute, building synergies between knowledge, resources, research, education and social activity in the fields of Humanities and Social Sciences."

Mission

"Recognizing the need to strengthen and upgrade teaching and research at all Sri Lankan universities, Realizing the need that universities should contribute to the development of the country and society through research and policy inputs,
NCAS shall support both theoretical and applied postgraduate, post-doctoral and other research in the Humanities and Social Sciences and promote advance thinking and creative originality by motivating and rewarding academics in that direction.
NCAS will be an apex body within Sri Lanka's university system networking with national and international organizations to achieve its objectives."

Introduction

The National Centre for Advanced Studies in Humanities and Social Sciences (NCAS) was established by Ordinance under the Universities Act No 16 of 1978 in September 2005 with the following specific objectives;

(1) to encourage and nurture reflective thinking and innovative ideas, and to support research characterized by creativity and originality, at national level especially within the University System, in fields falling within the scope of the Centre,

(2) to contribute to build national capacity to absorb new knowledge and advanced ideas;

(3) to provide opportunities for post-graduate studies and training, at levels comparable with those offered in their respective fields by similar internationally reputed centres of learning and research, under the guidance and supervision of academics and other specialists from national and foreign universities and from outside the University System;

(4) to contribute to the upgrading of human-resources and the development of academic and professional specializations in all fields falling within the scope of the Centre;

(5) to cater to the interest and capabilities of the emerging academic and professional communities in fields falling within the scope of the Centre.

The NCAS has been in operation on an interim basis until the end of 2007. Nevertheless, it made following significant achievements by 2024.

1. Selection and funding of about 528 academics to pursue their doctoral degrees overseas and in local universities.

2. Facilitating the academics in improving the knowledge and skills on new software (AMOS, EVIEWS, NVIVO) and exansion of its services, other expansion of the facilities from the NCAS website and extend usage of digital library.

3. Implementation of workshops, seminars and guest lectures to promote research and encourage academics, management skills of administrative staff and capacities of non- academic staff.

4. Successfully conducted of Annual Research Symposia and conducted the 6th International Research Symposium (IRSSSH) 2024 with the participation of national and international academics, researchers and eminent in the field.

Resources

Land and Buildings

The National Center for Advanced Studies in Humanities and Social Sciences (NCAS) is located in the down town Colombo at No. 6A, Sukhastan Gardens, Ward Place, Colombo 07, where it has been a place of easy access by anyone who is interested in engaging in his/her studies. Located in a highly residential area where the peace and quietness stays all the times, the place can call is an ideal place for advanced Studies with a calm and tranquil atmosphere in the middle of the town. Virtual enough that the NCAS fully owns the building and free of any rentals or long-term lease. It has its own car park enabling to park four vehicle at any one time, it has its own library, Computer laboratory and classrooms for the trainees to come and participate in their sessions.

Human Resources

The approved cadre and filled positions of NCAS as at 2024 are given in **Annexure 1.** With the aim of expanding its services and contributions, the NCAS revised its organogram and given in the **Annexure 2.**

Finance

The NCAS totally depends on the grants provided by the UGC/Treasury to meet its capital and recurrent expenditure requirements. The utilization of grants is given in the **Table 01** whereas the grants awarded during the year 2024 through two (02) cycles are given in **Table 02.**

Table 01- The Utilization of grants by NCAS from 2022-2024

Year	Released amount
2022	20,835,033.19
2023	36,615,984.22
2024	30,103,443.43
Total	**87,554,460.84**

Table 02- Details of the Grants awarded by NCAS in the year 2024

Year	Released	Pending	Total
2024 1st Round	7		07
2024 2nd Round	-	11	11
Total	07	11	18

SWOT ANALYSIS

Strengths	Availability of expertise through the Councils of the Organization. Satisfactory rapport between the Universities and the NCAS. Availability of dedicated staff. Availability of qualified staff to coordinate activities related to publication of Journals. Continuation of the Sri Lanka Journal of Advanced Social Studies. High demand for fee leaving academic causes introduced by NCAS. Fully equipped computer lab to facilitate for computer based academic causes. Purchase of expensive academic software such as AMOS,EVIEWS, NVIVO
Weaknesses	Rigid rules and regulations. Lack of research culture. Delay in receiving progress reports. Insufficient academic cadre provisions. Inadequate space at NCAS premises to expand activities. Scope limitations exist in mandates.
Opportunities	Increasing demand for Postgraduate qualifications for university academics. High demand for the workshops conducted for academic staff/administrative staff and non-academic staff. Capacity to have national and international collaborations. Feasibility to expose the institute to the international community. Ability to cater for the interest of both academic and public community
Threats	Limitations in government grants. More attractive grants schemes implemented by other organizations. More attractive training programs implemented by other organizations. Scholarship schemes implemented by other funding bodies. Brain drain (by learning) qualified senior academics. Union activities and conflicts which may interrupt the smooth functioning of universities. Lack of sound research culture among young academics.

STRATEGIC PLAN -2025-2029
CORPORATE GOALS, OBJECTIVES AND STRATEGIES

Goal No. 01: Facilitate Postgraduate Training Leading to PhDs/MPhil		
	Objective	Strategy
01	Increase the No. of PhD holders in State Universities	a) Provide financial assistance to academics to follow PhDs/M.Phil. in reputed local and foreign universities.
		b) Financial assistance for PhD Candidate sunder MOU with QUT (Ongoing).
		c) Financial assistance for PhD Candidates under MOU with QUT (New) (Split-Site)
02	Encourage university teachers and the interested Academic/ Professional holders for training on research	a) Organize and conduct training courses, appoint coordinators and dissemination of knowledge
Goal No. 02: Contribute to the Generation of Human Resource through Exchange Programs		
01	Introduce establish Scholarship Program/ exchange programs to promote Post Graduate Studies	a) Sign MoUs with recognized Universities/ Organizations
Goal No. 03: Cater for the interest and capability of the emerging academic and Professional Communities		
01	Cater for the academic community within and outside the University system to develop professional/ career skills	a) Conduct courses on Smart Literature Review (SLR),
		b) Organize programs that suit and encourage academics to expose themselves
Goal 04: Promote Research Capacities at National and International Level		
01	Dissemination of knowledge through research involvement, finding and scholarly work	a) Promote Research Culture by way of Conference to disseminate/Share new Research Findings
		b) Encourage Academics on Short term Research
02	Dissemination of research involvement finding and scholarly work by way of publications	a) Encourage academic publications & dissemination of knowledge
		b) Encourage academic publications & dissemination of knowledge through virtual platforms/ online portals to the global community

03	Dissemination and sharing research findings through incorporating pioneer international scholar participation by way of collaborating research projects	a) Invite international research scholars/ interested professionals and academics to visit Sri Lanka by affiliating to NCAS to carry on research projects in collaboration with Sri Lankan scholars/ institutes etc.,
Goal No. 05: Encourage and Nurture Reflecting new contributions towards Research Culture		
01	Provide access to a comprehensive collection of academic resources, including journals, books, research papers, and databases	Implement information sharing mechanism centering the NCAS
02	Make aware and involve university academics and interested scholars on current socio-economic research issues	Organize individual and collaborative project
03	Disseminate research Findings	
04	Encourage search for empirical evidence through aural history and socio-cultural interactions	a) Scholarly discussions with eminent in the fields and traditional knowledge hub etc. b) Preserving authentic/Traditional Knowledge related to "Humanities & Social sciences"
Goal 06: Enhance capacities of the Administrative Staff of University system and other Professional Bodies		
01	Empower Administrative and Non-Academic staff of university system	Provide training/ update knowledge on professional and administrative skills
Goal 07: Conduct training/ Proficiency/Efficiency programs for the Academic Support/ Non Academic Staff		
01	Empower Academic Support and Non-Academic staff of university system	Provide training for needy communities in the public/ private/ non-state sector education and vocational training
Goal 08- Develop Infrastructure of the NCAS Building Premises		
01	To facilitate and provide feasible environment for research, administrative and learning activities conducted by the Center	Improve the quality of the existing building premises of the NCAS
	Goal 09- Evolve the opportunities of unlimited learning	
01	To facilitate the marginalized and differently able communities by opening avenues through different modalities	Establish/ expand the Center for Life Long Learning and develop opportunities for needy communities.